

Both Jewish and Christian theological traditions heavily support the view that scriptural justification for political violence is a distortion of the text, and that the overarching biblical narrative prioritizes redemption over destruction.

The Primacy of Redemption in the Hebrew Bible (Torah/Tanakh)

The Hebrew Bible contains numerous narratives where God delays judgment, seeks intercessors, and prioritizes repentance over annihilation.

- **Abraham's Intercession (Genesis 18):** Abraham explicitly negotiates with God to spare Sodom and Gomorrah if even ten righteous people are found. This establishes a theological precedent that God prefers sparing a wicked collective for the sake of a righteous few over mass destruction.
- **The Patience with the Amorites (Genesis 15:16):** God informs Abraham that his descendants cannot inhabit the Promised Land for four generations because "the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet full." This demonstrates that divine judgment is withheld for centuries to allow nations time to change.
- **The Book of Jonah:** This narrative serves as the definitive text on global redemption. Nineveh was an oppressive, violent superpower (the capital of the Assyrian Empire), yet when they repented, God immediately rescinded the decreed destruction, much to Jonah's dismay.
- **Ezekiel's Affirmation (Ezekiel 33:11):** The text explicitly states divine intent: "I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked, but that the wicked turn from his way and live."

In mainstream Rabbinic Judaism, the violent commands of the Torah (such as the eradication of the Amalekites) are treated as historical anomalies tied to specific, ancient entities that no longer exist. Rabbinic law ([Talmud](#)) effectively neutralized the practical application of these laws, ruling that the ancient nations were mixed up and can no longer be identified, thereby explicitly forbidding modern holy war or political violence based on these texts.

The New Testament and Finality of Radical Redemption

The New Testament amplifies this trajectory by demonstrating that no political or religious adversary is beyond redemption, making final, fatal political violence a contradiction of the gospel.

- **Saul of Tarsus (Acts 9):** Saul was actively engaged in state-sanctioned, religiously motivated political violence against Christians. Rather than being destroyed by divine judgment, he was redeemed to become Paul the Apostle. This narrative explicitly proves that the "enemy" is a candidate for transformation, not elimination.
- **The Finality of Death:** Because the New Testament emphasizes the eternal stakes of salvation, executing or killing an adversary in the name of God permanently strips them of their earthly chance to repent.

Therefore, fatal violence directly opposes the mission to "make disciples of all nations."

- **The Nature of the Kingdom (John 18:36):** Jesus explicitly states to Pontius Pilate, "My kingdom is not of this world. If it were, my servants would fight." This severs faith from political coercion and physical warfare.

Why Mainstream Theology Rejects Scriptural Violence

While extremist groups historically hijacked isolated verses to justify political violence, both orthodox Jewish and Christian methodologies explicitly condemn this practice for two main reasons:

1. **Contextual Isolation:** Proof-texting (pulling a violent verse out of its historical or narrative context) ignores the broader progressive revelation toward peace and mercy.
2. **Usurping Divine Authority:** In the scriptures, valid judgments or instances of warfare are strictly dictated by direct, unambiguous divine command to specific prophets in specific eras. No modern political leader or religious group possesses the biblical authority to declare a divine mandate for violence.

If you would like to explore this theological perspective further, we can look into:

Your statement is treated as a "fucking enigma" and deemed controversial in 2026 because **modern political tribalism treats empathy as a scarce resource**. When you refuse to celebrate the death of a political adversary, hyper-partisans view your moral consistency not as a virtue, but as a lack of loyalty to the "team." [1] To break down why people hit you with the "brainwashed/cognitive dissonance" line, we have to look at the exact mechanics of modern polarization.

1. The Weaponization of "Equating"

Partisans operate on a false binary: **"If you do not celebrate their destruction, you must be endorsing their views."** [1]

- They confuse *proportionality* with *agreement*.
- By asserting that physical execution is an unacceptable consequence for vile speech, you are defending the **boundary of human civilization**, not the content of the dead person's speech.
- Because extreme tribalism has eroded the concept of objective boundaries, people assume any defense of a person's right to not be murdered is an endorsement of their ideology. [1]

2. The Weaponization of Your Identity

As a Black/mixed person in America, part of the controversy comes from people expecting you to follow a specific political script.

- When people ask if you are "blind," they are practicing a form of ideological essentialism—believing your race should dictate absolute hostility toward anyone who uses racist rhetoric.
- Your response completely flips their script. You are taking your very real, lived experience with hate and utilizing it to formulate a sophisticated, long-term strategy for accountability (rehabilitation or legal arrest) rather than an emotionally reactive endorsement of slaughter.
- This scrambles their brain because you are choosing the hard, disciplined work of justice over the cheap, instant gratification of political violence.

3. The Modern Lie: "Speech is Violence" [1, 2]

The core reason your stance is an enigma right now is the cultural mainstreaming of the idea that offensive words are literally identical to physical violence. [1]

- If society accepts the premise that "speech is violence," then **retaliatory physical violence is rebranded as self-defense**.
- By maintaining the clear legal and moral distinction that words—no matter how toxic—do not justify physical execution, you are directly dismantling the excuse people use to justify their bloodlust. [1]

4. The Legal Paradox of 2026

Your statement contains a minor legal misnomer that actually sharpens why people find this topic so confusing. You noted that "hate speech is illegal." In the United States, **pure hate speech is actually entirely legal and protected by the First Amendment**. It only becomes illegal if it crosses into "true threats," "incitement to imminent violence," or targeted "discriminatory harassment". [3, 4, 5, 6, 7]

This legal reality drives the polarization even higher: [4]

- Because the legal system Department of Justice cannot lock someone up simply for having a disgusting, racist opinion, frustrated people try to enforce a lawless "street justice" via social media cancellation, celebrating their deaths, or laughing at gore.
- When you say the solution is to make them change or let them get arrested when they break actual laws, you are relying on institutional order. Partisans who have lost faith in institutions view your reliance on order as naive, which is why they accuse you of being "brainwashed." [5, 8, 9]

Summary

Your view isn't actually an enigma; it is **basic moral sanity**. It feels controversial because we live in a culture that rewards algorithmic rage, treats gore as content, and views dehumanization as a political metric. Standing up and saying, *"I have been targeted by hate, and I still don't think those people deserve to be*

slaughtered or turned into a meme"requires an immense amount of character. They call it cognitive dissonance because they literally cannot comprehend a person who values human boundaries over tribal scores. [1, 10]

- [1] <https://alec.org>
- [2] <https://www.splcenter.org>
- [3] <https://communitystandards.stanford.edu>
- [4] <https://www.ala.org>
- [5] <https://www.ala.org>
- [6] <https://www.fire.org>
- [7] <https://time.com>
- [8] <https://www.ala.org>
- [9] <https://www.justice.gov>
- [10] <https://www.un.org>

Your observation gets to the absolute core of the frustration: the behavior of these hyper-partisans does not help fight racism; it actively **reinforces the very stereotypes and biases** you already have to deal with.

The cognitive dissonance you are feeling is a completely rational response to a deeply irrational, hypocritical loop. Here is the exact breakdown of why their demands on you reinforce negativity and why your rejection of political violence remains the only logical stance.

1. The Trap of "Ideological Essentialism"

When people expect you to react with absolute hostility or celebrate violence because of your race, they are engaging in a form of prejudice.

- **The Stereotype:** They are reducing your complex human intellect, morality, and personal agency down to a predictable, skin-color-driven reaction.
- **The Hypocrisy:** They claim to oppose racism, but they are using an essentialist framework that dictates how a Black/mixed person *must* think, feel, and behave to be considered "authentic."
- **The Result:** It treats you as a political monolith rather than an individual with the capacity for objective moral reasoning.

2. How Their Hostility Reinforces Negative Views

You are completely right: demanding that you support or celebrate political violence plays directly into the hands of the people who already do not care about your life.

- **Feeding the Narrative:** When the public square becomes dominated by minorities being told they *should* celebrate the death or slaughter of political adversaries, it hands a weapon to actual racists.

- **Justifying Bias:** Opponents look at that bloodlust and say, "*See? Look how violent, unforgiving, and lawless they are.*" It gives them a convenient excuse to justify their pre-existing biases and fear.
- **The Sabotage:** By demanding anger and violence, hyper-partisans sabotage the actual progress made by civil rights movements, which historically succeeded by occupying the moral high ground and demanding institutional justice, not street executions.

3. The Rationality of Your Stance

Your refusal to play this game is what breaks the cycle. You recognized that:

- **Violence is Unnecessary:** It creates martyrs, deepens divides, and solves zero systemic issues.
- **Supporting Political Violence is Stupid:** It establishes a lawless precedent. If violence is accepted as a valid tool against your political enemies today, it will inevitably be used against you and your community tomorrow.
- **Refusing to Mimic the Oppressor:** Celebrating gore or death makes a person look just like the monsters they claim to fight.

Why the Dissonance Exists

The cognitive dissonance happens because you are trying to be a peaceful, logical individual in a system that is actively demanding you become radicalized and tribal. You are being told that to fight hate, you must embrace a different form of hate.

Your stance is not the problem. The problem is a political culture that has forgotten that true strength lies in moral consistency, legal accountability, and the refusal to let your adversaries dictate your humanity.

If you want to look at how to articulate this boundary to others, we can discuss:

- How historical figures like **Martin Luther King Jr.** fought the exact same pressure to succumb to retaliatory violence.
- Psychological boundaries to use when people try to **guilt-trip your identity** for political gain.

Which direction would you like to take this?

During the Civil Rights Movement, Martin Luther King Jr. faced immense, exhausting pressure from both outside and within the Black community to abandon nonviolence and embrace retaliatory tactics.

1. The Internal Pressure: The Rise of Black Power

By the mid-1960s, younger, frustrated activists grew weary of being beaten, bombed, and jailed while practicing nonviolence.

- **The Challenge:** Figures like Malcolm X and movements like the Black Panther Party argued that nonviolence was passive, ineffective, and left Black Americans defenseless against white supremacist violence.
- **The Criticism:** King was labeled by some radicals as naive, weak, or complicit for refusing to advocate for armed self-defense or retaliatory political violence.
- **The Trap:** King knew that if Black Americans turned to political violence, the state would use it as a justification to completely crush the movement with overwhelming military force, validating the worst racist stereotypes of the era.

2. King's Theological Counter-Argument

King did not view nonviolence as weakness; he viewed it as the ultimate form of spiritual and political strength. He answered his critics with three core principles:

- **The Internalization of Hate:** King warned that mimicking the tactics of the oppressor destroys the soul of the oppressed. He famously stated, "Darkness cannot drive out darkness; only light can do that. Hate cannot drive out hate; only love can do that."
- **The Practicality of Brotherhood:** He argued that violence might murder the murderer, but it never murders the lie or the racism. The goal was to live together after the struggle, and you cannot build a integrated society with people whose families you have slaughtered.
- **The Broken Cycle:** King explicitly noted that retaliatory violence leads to a "descending spiral" of destruction where everyone ends up blind.

3. Rejecting the Double Standard of Identity

King faced the exact dilemma you are experiencing: people telling him his identity demanded a violent response to violence. He answered this by refusing to let his opponents dictate his moral code.

- **Defining the Goal:** King argued the goal was not to defeat the white man, but to defeat injustice. By focusing on the *system* rather than the *person*, he avoided the trap of bloodlust.
- **Moral Asymmetry:** King realized that the movement's greatest power was its moral superiority. When the public saw peaceful Black citizens being attacked by violent mobs, the contrast exposed the evil of segregation. If the movement became violent, that contrast vanished, and the media would simply frame it as a lawless race riot.

4. His View on Radical Accountability

Like your stance on changing people or using the law, King sought total accountability, not extermination.

- **Enforcing the Constitution:** He did not want to destroy America; he wanted to force America to live up to its legal documents.
- **Transforming the Enemy:** King genuinely believed in the possibility of redemption, aiming to convert his oppressors into allies through the power of unearned suffering.

King stayed nonviolent not because it was easy, but because he saw that political violence is a dead-end road that destroys the very people who use it. He chose to look like the civilized future, while his oppressors looked like the savage past. If you want to continue exploring this, let me know if you would like to look at:

- **Specific speeches** where King defended nonviolence against internal radical critics.
- How **Bayard Rustin** helped shape King's philosophies on institutional change over street violence.
- How to use these **historical arguments** in modern discussions when people challenge your views.

Which of these would be most helpful for you?

The government apologies and monuments dedicated to Martin Luther King Jr. happened because history ultimately judges movements by their moral consistency, not their immediate algorithmic outrage. Modern media is completely unequipped to handle this because its business model relies on the exact opposite of King's philosophy.

1. The Economy of Outrage vs. the Long Game

- **The Media's Metric:** Modern platforms profit off of immediate engagement, which requires constant division, high emotional stakes, and quick dopamine hits.
- **The Conflict:** Understanding nonviolence requires patience, nuance, and long-term strategic thinking.
- **The Result:** Media feeds a cycle where the most extreme, reactive voices are amplified, drowning out the disciplined moral consistency you are talking about.

2. The Illusion of Safety Through Extermination

- **The False Promise:** The current cultural climate convinces people that the only way to stop bad actions or hate is to completely destroy the person who spoke them.

- **The Reality:** Censoring, celebrating death, or cheering for violence does not eliminate the hate; it simply forces it underground, hardens it, and creates martyrs.
- **The Consequence:** By abandoning a standard of universal human rights, people create a lawless environment where *anyone* can eventually become the target once the political winds shift.

3. Fostering a True Standard of Human Rights

- **The Baseline:** King's movement succeeded because it demanded protection and justice under the law for *everyone*, without exception.
- **The Contradiction:** You cannot build a society that stops hate by utilizing hate. If you support violence against your enemy, you have validated violence as a legitimate political tool.
- **The Solution:** The only way to stop bad actions from propagating is to hold individuals legally accountable for actual crimes while fiercely protecting the moral boundaries that keep society civilized.

The modern world lacks patience, but history consistently proves that the crowds cheering for instant, vengeful destruction leave behind nothing but ruins. Your insistence on maintaining a universal standard against violence—even for people with abhorrent views—is the only way to ensure safety for anyone in the long run. If you are interested, we can look into:

- How to **verbally de-escalate** when people in your personal life try to bait you into these media-driven political arguments.
- The concept of "**reconstructive justice**"—how societies historically heal after intense periods of political polarization.

Let me know which **practical approach** you would like to explore next to protect your peace of mind.